

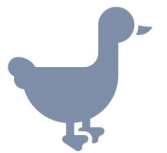
– Résumé –

CF

– Module –

LANG2 – S2 – 1CS

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Unit 1 : Foundations of Media and Information Literacy (MIL)

Vocabulary

Media : all electronic or digital means and print or artistic visuals used to transmit messages.	Literacy : the ability to encode and decode symbols and synthesize and analyze messages	Media literacy : the ability to encode and decode the symbols transmitted via media and the ability to synthesize, analyze and produce mediated messages	Media use : how, when, and why we spend our time with media
Traditional media : communication that was well-established before the Internet age; books, newspapers, magazines, etc.	Social media : websites and applications that enable users to create and share content or to participate in social networking.	Mass media : any type of media that reaches a large number of people.	Information literacy : a set of competencies that empowers citizens to access, retrieve, understand, evaluate and use, to create as well as share information and media content in all formats, using various tools, in a critical, ethical and effective way, in order to participate and engage in personal, professional and societal activities.
Types of media : newspapers, magazines, radio, television, internet, outdoor media.	Bias : the action of supporting or opposing a particular person or thing in an unfair way, because of allowing personal opinions to influence your judgment.	Deepfake : AI-generated videos that depict events or actions that never occurred, created by combining images to mimic real footage.	Viral : information that spreads quickly like a virus especially through social media
Media outlet : a means of mass communication, such as a newspaper, magazine, television station, radio station, or a Web site.	Infodemic : an excessive amount of information about a problem that is typically unreliable, spreads rapidly, and makes a solution more difficult to achieve.	Pseudoscience : a fake or false science that makes claims based on little or no scientific evidence.	Voice cloning : AI technology analyzing speech patterns to mimic vocal characteristics
Framing : shaping information in a way that influences how it is interpreted.	Media and Information Literacy (MIL) : an umbrella concept that covers three often clearly distinguished dimensions : information literacy, media literacy and ICT/ digital literacy	Misinformation : untrue or wrong information	Disinformation : false information purposely disseminated, usually by a government, for the purpose of creating a false impression

Cynicism : an inclination to believe that people are motivated purely by self-interest; skepticism.	Red Herring : a fallacy that introduces an irrelevant issue to divert attention from the subject under discussion	Propaganda : ideas spread to influence public opinion for or against a cause.	Digital Literacy : the ability to access, manage, understand, integrate, communicate, evaluate and create information safely and appropriately through digital technologies for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship. It includes competences that are variously referred to as computer literacy, ICT literacy, information literacy and media literacy
Predictive search : an autocomplete feature that anticipates the search a user is trying to perform based on common searches, trending searches, the user's location, and the user's search history	Digital assistant : a program using artificial intelligence and voice recognition software to understand voice commands. It allows users to interact with devices and retrieve information using their voices	Content filtering : the process of analyzing conversations or content to identify and prioritize the most relevant information.	Digital marketing : technology that analyzes patterns in online data to highly targeted and personalized ads that are tailored to anticipated wants and needs
Fact vs. Opinion : we differentiate between facts and opinions based on the criteria of verifiability. Facts are verifiable and can be objectively confirmed, while opinions are subjective and based on personal beliefs.	Emotive language : words used deliberately to create an emotional impact	Evaluative language : language that conveys the sender's attitude rather than simply offering an objective description	Selective focus : selective focus occurs when a source focuses on a small selection of the facts and opinions available on the issue discussed. In order to find out whether a source has issues with selective focus, it's important to look for what's left out.
Expertise : refers to the level of knowledge and competence in a particular field.	Peer review process : a way in which scholars evaluate research manuscripts before they are published in order to ensure their quality.	Fact-checking : the process of checking information for accuracy and verification.	Open Educational Resources : OER are learning, teaching and research materials in any format and medium that reside in the public domain or are under copyright that have been released under an open license, that permit no-cost access, re-use, re-purpose, adaptation and redistribution by others.

N.B : I kept the original definitions from the flashcards. If you want shorter versions, check out **Wa3adi 3aicha's** doc and don't forget to pray for her <3 (but use her real name : Ouadi Chaima) :

https://docs.google.com/document/d/15Fjaobd1KKvncNAPeMPPLa_bcW5lN97pOXn_Bf_ZJmQ/edit?tab=t.5c0mrsujlfpc

Grammar : Basic sentence constituents

N.B. : note that according to Boussoualim's email, this is not included in our CF. But, it's useful to know (some stuff from here are mentioned in the lesson about passive voice, which is included in the exam).

A sentence is a string of words (shocking information, I know). **Words** :

- ✓ Belong to different **grammatical classes** (nouns, verbs, adjectives, and adverbs), which describe **what words are**.
- ✓ Can achieve different **grammatical functions** (subject, object, complement, adverbial), which describe **what words do**.

Grammatical classes - Phrases

Depending on their *grammatical class*, words can be grouped into **phrases**. Phrases belong to different **classes** :

Phrase class	Example
Noun phrase (NP)	The enormous number of changes
Verb phrase (VP)	have made
Adjective phrase (AP)	faster, smaller, more reliable
Adverb phrase (Adv. P)	very quickly, more efficiently
Preposition phrase (PP)	in recent decades, on the desk

- **Adverb Phrases** often describe **how, when, where, or to what extent** something happens.
Example : *very quickly, as soon as possible, more efficiently*
 - **Prepositional Phrases** begin with a **preposition** (in, on, at, by, for, with, etc.) and end with a **noun or pronoun**.
Example : *in the morning, on the desk, with a screwdriver*
- ⚠ Many **prepositional phrases** act as **adverbials** when they tell **where/when/how** something happens (ex : in a house).

Examples : Consider the following sentences. Each one of them consists of many words grouped into different phrases :

- The enormous number of changes in computers in recent decades have made them faster, smaller, cheaper, more reliable, and easier to use.
- NP** **PP** **VP** **NP** **AP**
- The technician repaired the computer in less than an hour.
- NP** **VP** **NP** **Adv. P**
- Even **single words**
can be a phrase !

Grammatical functions - Clauses

- ❖ Depending on their *grammatical function*, words can be grouped into **clauses**. Each clause contains a basic structure : **subject** and **predicate**. This basic structure is called an **independent clause**.

Example : The enormous number of changes in computers in recent decades have made them faster, smaller, cheaper, more reliable, and easier to use.

subject **predicate**

- ❖ There are five **types of predicates**, and therefore five **types (structures) of independent clauses**, where the **type of the verb** determines *which* other **sentence constituents** must follow to express a complete meaning.

❖ Let's discover the **sentence constituents** first :

Constituent	Exemple
Subject (S)	The <i>technician</i> fixed the issue.
Verb (V)	The technician <i>fixed</i> the issue.
Indirect object (I)	She gave <i>me</i> the file.
Direct Object (O)	She gave me <i>the file</i> .
Complement (C)	The laptop is <i>fast</i> .

Quick tips :

- **Verb** : the *action*.
- **Indirect object** : the *recipient* of the action (usually a person).
- **Direct object** : the thing/person *affected by* the action.
- **Complement** : gives *more information* about **S** or **O**.

Not all clauses use all 5 constituents. The **verb type** determines which are needed.

❖ Now, here are the five **types of an independent clause**, depending on the verb type :

Verb type	Structure (of the sentence constituents)	Example
Transitive (no object verb)	SV	The system crashed
Monotransitive (1 object verb)	SVO	I bought a new computer
Ditransitive (2 object verb)	SVIO	This summary is giving me a headache
Linking (complement verb)	SVC	My new computer is fast but expensive
Complex transitive (object-complement verb)	SVOC	My old computer was driving me crazy

⚠ Some verbs belong to **more than one type** ! Take for example the verb « make » :

- ✓ ChatGPT is making us dumb → object-complement verb.
- ✓ She made a birthday cake → object verb.
- ✓ She made her sister a DIY birthday gift → two-object verb.

⚠ On top of the five main constituents, predicates (and clauses) can also contain **adverbials**, which are generally optional. For example : « The computer shop assistant gave me the technical specifications of many computers **[before I made my choice]** » ; "before I made my choice" functions as an adverbial which we can **choose to add or not add** to the sentence.

Some adverbials though are **required** to complete the meaning of the sentence. For example : « I saved the work **in a flashdrive** ».

❖ **Types of clauses :**

1. Independent clause : can stand alone grammatically and is not introduced with subordinating conjunctions like **although, if, because** or **when**.

Example 1 : « Computers are useful » **simple sentence**, formed of one independent clause.

Example 2 : « Computers are useful, but they should be used in a responsible way » **compound sentence**, formed of two independent clauses.

2. Dependent clause : cannot stand alone. It's used with an independent clause in a **complex sentence**.

Example : « Computers are useful if they're used properly ».

Unit 2 : MIL for Science Communication

Vocabulary

Perspectives articles : perspectives take the form of a review that provide the reader with an overview of the subject and give a personal insight into the advances and challenges the future may hold. Perspectives can be selective in their coverage rather than an in-depth review of an area.	Critical review : a piece of writing that evaluates the ideas or artistic qualities of another work	Algorithmic bias : bias embedded into algorithms and any level of software development	News release : a news release is a written statement about a matter of public interest which is given to the press by an organization concerned with the matter.
Supervised classification : a supervised machine learning method where the model tries to predict the correct label of a given input data. In classification, the model is fully trained using the training data, and then it is evaluated on test data before being used to perform prediction on new unseen data.	Empirical research articles : research that is based on observation and measurement of phenomena, as directly experienced by the researcher	Off-the-shelf machine learning tools : readily available software or libraries that provide pre-built algorithms and frameworks for machine learning tasks. These tools can be used without the need for extensive customization or programming from scratch. They are designed to be user-friendly and accessible, allowing researchers and practitioners to implement standard machine learning techniques without deep expertise in the algorithms or underlying mathematics.	

Grammar 1 : Use of tense in scientific papers

Tense	Use	Example
<i>Past</i>	Describe what the authors did : the actions they completed to demonstrate their argument.	We analyzed 150 samples.
	Report authors' observations while completing the experiments	We noticed irregular patterns in the data.
	Report what other researchers did	Smith et al. conducted a similar study in 2021.
<i>Present</i>	Describe general truths drawn by the authors.	AI improves decision-making in healthcare.
	Describe atemporal facts (referring to figures and tables or to what the paper covers)	Figure 3 shows the error rate distribution.
	Describe duration until now	Many researchers focus on ethical AI.
<i>Future</i>	Point to what will or could happen	This approach will likely require further validation.

⚠ Usually, most of the paper is written in the **past**, in the **methods** and **results** sections and in the **related works** section. The **present** is less used, and it is mainly found in the **discussion** section. The **future** is found in the **perspectives** (if any).

By the way, here are some details about the **structure of an empirical research article** :

Article section	The questions it answers
<i>Introduction</i>	What is the problem investigated? - Why is this research relevant (what's the need)? - What was studied? - What was the hypothesis?
<i>Methods</i>	What procedure was used? - What methods and approaches were used?
<i>Results</i>	What are the main findings?
<i>Discussion</i>	How did the authors interpret the results? - What is the rationale for the specific approaches used (the suggested and selected methods and approaches) in the study?

Grammar 2 : Uses of passive in scientific papers

General considerations : In passive constructions, the subject receives the action instead of doing it (unlike in the active voice). The passive is used to :

- Describe **what happened** : « *The instructions are stored in memory* ».
 - Indicate **who did the action** : « *The instructions are executed by the processor* ».
 - Explain **how the action was done** : « *They are represented in the binary system* ».
- Passive voice is also used when :
- The agent is **unknown or unimportant** : « *Instructions are written in Python* ».
 - The subject is **long or complex** : « *The instructions are executed by the CPU, or central processing unit...* ».

Common Uses of the Passive :

- **Describing processes or procedures**, especially in scientific/technical contexts to emphasize outcomes over the actor.
 - **Reporting experiments** objectively.
- **Using certain verbs** (e.g., claim, blame) where the doer is unimportant.
 - **Expressing opinions impersonally** : *It is argued that...*
 - **Avoiding responsibility** : *The computer got virused, sir.*

Types of Verbs Used in the Passive

- **Transitive verbs** : *The question was answered.*
- **Two-object verbs** : *A silver cup was given to the winner.*
 - **Object-complement verbs** are allowed.
- **Linking verbs** and verbs without objects are **not** used in the passive.
(refer to the lesson about sentence constituents)

Passive vs. Adjectival constructions

Both forms use **be + past participle**, but context clarifies usage :

- **Adjective** : *My computer was virused.* (state)
- **Passive verb** : *My computer was virused when I used your flash drive.* (action)

Verbs with a that-clause

Verbs like *believe, say, think* (followed by a that-clause in active voice) become passive with an **infinitive**, for example :

Active : People think *that* she **is** a genius.

Passive : She is thought **to be** a genius.

Verbs followed by bare infinitives

Verbs like *make, let, help* (they're followed by bare infinitives in active voice) take a **full infinitive** in the passive, for example :

Active : Adding memory makes your computer **work** faster.

Passive : The computer is made **to work** faster by adding memory.

Passive in Scientific Writing

Reasons for using the passive in academic texts :

- **Objectivity** : Focus on process/action over the actor.
 - **Formality** : Creates a professional tone.
- **Emphasis** : Highlights the action/result rather than the agent.

Plagiarism and Citation in APA

According to the APA (American Psychological Association), plagiarism is “The act of presenting the words, ideas, or images of another as your own,” regardless of intent, which **violates ethical standards** in academia.

- To avoid plagiarism, always **attribute sources** when quoting, paraphrasing, or reusing tables, figures, or images.
 - Usually use **author-date citations**.
- For reused visuals, **copyright attribution or permission** may be required.

Citing Sources: In-Text Citations (APA Style)

You must use both **in-text citations** and a **reference list**.

In-text citations

In-text citations appear in two formats :

Format 1 : Quoting Sources :

- For **≤ 40 words** : Quote in the paragraph with **double quotation** marks.
- For **> 40 words** : Use **block format, indented** with **no quotation marks** added.

In both cases, we can use one of these two **citation styles** :

1. Narrative citation (Author in the sentence), for example (< 40 words) :

Frey and Fisher (2010) argued that academic motivation requires a meaningful task, “*tailored to the developmental, academic, and social needs of students*” (p. 30).

2. Parenthetical citation (Author in parentheses), for example (< 40 words) :

We know from research that the work involved with engineering occurs within a fundamentally oral environment where communication skills are the “*lifeblood of a practicing engineer*” (Darling & Dannels, 2003, p. 15).

⚠ Use “**and**” in narrative citations, and “**&**” in parenthetical ones.

⚠ **Difference between quoting in paragraph (≤ 40 words) and block format (> 40 words) :** in block quotes, the citation comes **after the final punctuation** and the closing parenthesis is **not followed by any additional punctuation**. For example :

Richardson-Tench et al. (2014) described how a potential researcher selects a problem to research :

The researcher must have the appropriate experience and skills to address the research problem. Frequently, research experience is related to qualifications. Beginning skills can be learnt in undergraduate programs, although many such programs are now focusing on the reparation of research consumers rather than researchers. (p. 31)

⚠ When a source that has **three or more authors** is cited, include the name of **only the first author** plus “**et al.**” as in the example above.

Format 2 : Paraphrasing Sources :

Paraphrasing means restating an author’s ideas in *your own words*.

- Cite the **source**, but *page numbers are optional*.
- Misparaphrasing may lead to unintentional plagiarism.
- Structure your paragraph clearly to show you’re paraphrasing one specific source throughout.
 - You can use either **citation styles** (narrative or parenthetical).

Examples :

Narrative citation : The author of the source is included into the structure of the sentence followed by the year of publication in parenthesis.

Veish and Langer (2015, p. 39) found that microneedle patches for monitoring a diabetic patients' blood glucose levels helps them to easily manage their need for insulin.

Parenthetical citation : The authors of the source are not included in the sentence, but they are cited in parenthesis together with the date of publication.

Communication underpins the evolution of every field of science (**Penrose & Katz, 2010**).

⚠ Do not place the citation only at the end of a paragraph if you are paraphrasing multiple sentences from one source — it creates ambiguity and counts as plagiarism.

⚠ A semi-colon « ; » is used to separate a **list of sources** in a single citation.

⚠ **Secondary sources :** if you cite a source that *has been cited in the source you read*, refer to it using “**as cited in**”, for example :

« Hayes (**as cited in Bell & Waters, 2014, p. 183**) stated that research focus groups... »

or

« Research focus groups... (**Hayes, 2000, as cited in Bell & Waters, 2014**) »

Reference list

- Every source cited in-text must appear in the reference list.
- Do not include sources you did not use.

Unit 3 : Foundations of Media and Information Literacy (MIL)

Vocabulary

Mainstream media : forms of the media, especially traditional forms such as newspapers, television, and radio rather than the internet, that influence large numbers of people and are likely to represent generally accepted beliefs and opinions

Citizen journalism : people who are not professional journalists but who disseminate information using Web sites, blogs, and social media.

New media : products and services that provide information or entertainment using computers or the internet, and not by traditional methods such as television and newspapers

Confirmation bias : the tendency to search for or interpret information in a way that confirms one's preconceptions. When information aligns with our own opinions or experiences, we're more likely to interact with it.

Algorithmic Bias : bias embedded into algorithms and any level of software development (this one's repeated, yes)	Bias by omission : when the media leaves out one side or aspect of a story.	Bias by placement : it happens when stories that are important for our daily lives don't receive important placement in media messages. It can also happen when unimportant stories get important placement in media messages.	Framing : the way an issue is posed ; how an issue is worded can significantly affect decisions and judgments.
Opinion article : persuasive article, which can be written by a staff member or anyone else	News report : a short account of the news	Clickbait headlines : sensational headlines designed to tempt Internet users to click through to a specific web site	Firsthand account : an account directly from an original or primary source; coming from or being a direct personal observation or experience.
The Filter Bubble : Eli Pariser's theory that personalization on websites and social media creates a filter bubble sending us only information, news, and suggestions that confirm our views and likes -- distancing us from other information (filtering the other opinions).	Echo chambers : a metaphor used for the situation when our sources of information and opinion have all been selected to support our opinions and preferences. This includes our own selection of media and friends with similar viewpoints, but also results from the fact that social media tailors what we see using an algorithm designed to engage us.	✧ Ethos : ethical appeal (credibility). ✧ Pathos : emotional appeal. ✧ Logos : logical appeal.	

Shoutout to **Akal Ahlem** (à confirmer).

That's all there is to this summary. Good luck !

FIN !! 